

“Why is this like this?”

I don’t know, why is it? Remove the “why,” and there’s your open road.

“Do I have to?”

Do you? Remove the “have to.” There’s your open road.

“I wish there was . . .”

What do you wish? If you wish, others wish too. Make wishes come true, and there’s your open road.

“I’m tired of . . .”

What are you tired of? Fix someone’s tiresomeness, and there’s your open road.

“This sucks . . .”

What sucks? Remove or reduce suckage, and there’s your open road.

Opportunity is dressed in predictable code words that illuminate its presence. For example, I’m a sloppy eater. A white shirt plus spaghetti and forget it. Aside from the slop, I have a nasty knack of biting my lip on the inside of my mouth. When I bite myself, a canker sore forms every time. I’ve had canker sore issues since grade school. They’re not problematic unless I accidentally bite my lip or mouth. The last canker sore I had lasted a week and was excruciatingly painful. “I’m tired of these canker sores!” I bellyached. Notice the language “I’m tired . . .” Ring ring, opportunity!

My discomfort led me to the Internet for canker sore research. I found some conflicting conjecture and information on how to prevent them. Some people recommended Vitamin X while others recommended Herb Y. (Vitamin X and Herb Y is not the real name because I’m protecting my formula!) So, I bought Vitamin X and Herb Y and waited until my next chewing mistake.

Then it happened. While eating some oatmeal, I bit my lip. A few days later I felt a canker sore brewing at the bite location. I loaded up on Vitamin X and Herb Y. Remarkably, the canker sore never formed, and it appeared that Vitamin X and Herb Y worked as a canker sore preventive. Now, anytime I feel a canker sore brewing from an earlier bite wound, I repeat this process, and each time, the sore does not form. I haven’t had a canker sore in nearly two years! I went from one every other month to none.

My opportunity is clear. I could market my special “canker formula” to the masses. I have control, decent entry barriers, scale, and time. How many people suffer from canker sores? How many canker prevention formulas are out there? A few, but are they being marketed well? Can I execute better?

The opportunities of open roads come in easily painted language: Discomfort,